

LESSON

1. Passage anchor

> “I first met her when I was about fifteen, in my very first physics **lesson** in secondary school.”

Passage meaning

lesson = a period of time in which someone is taught a particular subject or skill

課；一堂課；課堂

Here:

> **physics lesson**

= **物理課**；一堂物理課

Practice

1. Our first **lesson** was about forces and motion.

我們第一堂**課**是關於力和運動。

2. I still remember my first English **lesson** at secondary school.

我仍然記得中學第一堂英文**課**。

Core meanings of LESSON

2. lesson — a period of teaching

= a period during which a teacher teaches a subject or skill

一堂課；課堂

Examples

1. The **lesson** starts at nine o'clock.

這堂**課**九點開始。

2. Today's **lesson** was much more interesting than yesterday's.

今天這堂**課**比昨天有趣得多。

This is the exact passage sense.

3. lesson in + subject

= a teaching session about a particular subject

.....課；關於.....的一堂課

Examples

1. We had a **lesson in physics** this morning.
我們今天早上上了一堂**物理課**。
2. She gave the class a **lesson in grammar**.
她給全班上了一堂**文法課**。

4. have a lesson

= attend or take part in a teaching session

上課；有一堂課

Examples

1. I **have a piano lesson** after school.
我放學後有一堂**鋼琴課**。
2. We **had a science lesson** before lunch.
我們午餐前上了一堂**科學課**。

5. give / teach a lesson

= provide a teaching session

上課；授課

Examples

1. She **gave us a lesson** on electricity.
她給我們上了一堂關於電的**課**。
2. He **teaches private lessons** at weekends.
他週末會上**私人課程**。

Private instruction

6. lesson — private or individual instruction

= a teaching session, often one-to-one or in a small group, for learning a skill

****私人課；個別課程****

Examples

1. She takes weekly piano ****lessons****.

她每星期上一次鋼琴****課****。

2. I signed up for driving ****lessons****.

我報名了駕駛****課程****。

7. driving / music / swimming lesson

= instructional session for learning a practical skill

****駕駛課 / 音樂課 / 游泳課****

Examples

1. My first ****driving lesson**** was terrifying.

我第一堂****駕駛課****很可怕。

2. The children have ****swimming lessons**** every Saturday.

孩子們每星期六上****游泳課****。

Material to be learned

8. lesson — material taught or assigned

= a section of material that is taught or learned

****課；課文；學習單元****

Examples

1. Please read ****Lesson 5**** before tomorrow.

請在明天之前讀完****第五課****。

2. Today we are starting a new ****lesson**** in the textbook.

今天我們要開始課本裡的新****單元 / 課文****。

This is common in textbooks and language learning.

9. Lesson 1 / Lesson 2 etc.

= numbered unit in a course or textbook

第一課 / 第二課等

Examples

1. Vocabulary is introduced in **Lesson 3**.

詞彙會在**第三課**介紹。

2. We finished **Lesson 6** yesterday.

我們昨天完成了**第六課**。

Experience that teaches you something

10. lesson — something learned from experience

= useful knowledge, wisdom, or understanding gained from an experience

教訓；經驗；得到的啟示

Examples

1. I learned an important **lesson** from that mistake.

我從那次錯誤中學到了一個重要**教訓**。

2. The experience taught her a valuable **lesson** about patience.

那段經歷讓她在耐心這件事上學到了一個寶貴的**教訓**。

This is a major figurative sense.

11. learn a lesson

= understand something important because of experience, often a mistake or difficulty

吸取教訓；學到一課

Examples

1. I definitely **learned my lesson**.

我真的**得到教訓了**。

2. He finally **learned a lesson** from the experience.
他終於從那段經歷中**吸取了教訓**。

12. learn your lesson

= learn not to repeat a mistake because of an unpleasant experience
得到教訓；記取教訓

Examples

1. I forgot my umbrella and got soaked—I've **learned my lesson**.
我忘了帶傘，結果全身濕透——我已經**得到教訓了**。
2. Hopefully he has **learned his lesson** and won't do it again.
希望他已經**記取教訓**，不會再犯。

Often implies correction after a mistake.

Moral / message

13. lesson — moral or message from a story/event

= an idea about how people should behave or what can be learned from a story or situation
寓意；啟示；教訓

Examples

1. The story contains an important **lesson** about honesty.
這個故事包含一個關於誠實的重要**啟示**。
2. The main **lesson** of the film is that trust takes time.
這部電影的主要**寓意**是信任需要時間建立。

14. lesson for someone

= something that provides a warning or example for another person
給某人的教訓 / 借鏡

Examples

1. His mistake should be a **lesson** for all of us.
他的錯誤應該成為我們所有人的**借鏡**。
2. The accident was a painful **lesson** for the company.
那場事故對公司來說是一個沉痛的**教訓**。

Punitive sense

15. teach someone a lesson

= punish or make someone suffer so they will not repeat bad behavior
給某人一個教訓

Examples

1. He wanted to **teach them a lesson**.
他想**給他們一個教訓**。
2. The fine was intended to **teach drivers a lesson**.
這項罰款是想**給駕駛人一個教訓**。

This can sound threatening depending on context.

Warning from history / events

16. lesson from history

= conclusion or warning drawn from past events
歷史教訓；歷史給人的啟示

Examples

1. One **lesson from history** is that poor communication can worsen conflict.
一個重要的**歷史教訓**是溝通不良可能使衝突惡化。
2. Governments often claim to have learned the **lessons of the past**.
政府常聲稱已經吸取了**過去的教訓**。

17. lessons learned

= knowledge or conclusions gained after completing an activity, project, or experience

****經驗教訓；心得；汲取的經驗****

Examples

1. The team discussed the ****lessons learned**** from the project.
團隊討論了從專案中得到的****經驗教訓****。
2. We should document the ****lessons learned**** for future projects.
我們應該記錄這次的****經驗心得****，供未來專案參考。

Very common in business and project contexts.

Formal / institutional use

18. lesson plan

= teacher's plan for what will be taught and how during a lesson

****教案；課堂計畫****

Examples

1. The teacher prepared a detailed ****lesson plan****.
老師準備了一份詳細的****教案****。
2. A good ****lesson plan**** includes clear objectives.
好的****教案****會包括清楚的學習目標。

19. lesson objective

= specific learning goal for a lesson

****課堂目標；學習目標****

Examples

1. The ****lesson objective**** was to understand reflection of light.
這堂課的****學習目標****是理解光的反射。
2. The teacher explained the ****lesson objectives**** at the beginning.
老師在開始時說明了****課堂目標****。

Religious use

20. lesson — reading from scripture

In some religious traditions:

= a passage from scripture read during a service

****經文選讀；經課****

Examples

1. The first ****lesson**** was read from the Old Testament.

第一段****經文選讀****取自《舊約》。

2. She read the ****lesson**** during the service.

她在禮拜中朗讀了****經文****。

Established but lower-priority for general learners.

Related forms

21. lesson-related family: teach / teacher / learning

****lesson**** is closely connected semantically with:

* teach → ****教****

* teacher → ****老師****

* learn → ****學；學會****

* learning → ****學習****

But these are separate lexical items rather than direct morphological derivatives.

Countability

22. lesson is countable

Correct:

* a lesson

- * one lesson
- * three lessons

Examples

1. We had **two lessons** today.

我們今天上了**兩堂課**。

2. It was an important **lesson**.

那是一個重要的**教訓**。

The countable noun works in both the classroom and figurative senses.

Key contrasts

23. lesson vs class

lesson

= a specific period or unit of teaching

一堂課；教學單元

class

can mean:

1. the group of students
2. the teaching period
3. a course/category

Compare:

> Today's **lesson** is about light.

> 今天這堂課講光。

> The whole **class** looked confused.

> 全班都看起來很困惑。

A class can contain many lessons over time.

24. lesson vs course

lesson

= one individual teaching session or unit

****course****

= organized series of lessons over a longer period

****課程****

Compare:

> I had one piano ****lesson**** today.

> 我今天上了一堂鋼琴課。

> I enrolled in a twelve-week piano ****course****.

> 我報名了一個十二週的鋼琴課程。

25. lesson vs lecture

****lesson****

= teaching session, often interactive and common in schools or skill learning

****lecture****

= longer formal talk, especially in higher education

****講課 ; 講座****

Compare:

> a secondary-school physics ****lesson****

> 中學物理課

> a university physics ****lecture****

> 大學物理講課

26. lesson vs tutorial

****tutorial****

= small-group or individual teaching session emphasizing discussion, guidance, or practice

****輔導課 ; 教程****

****lesson****

is broader.

A tutorial is a type of teaching session, but not every lesson is a tutorial.

27. lesson vs subject

****subject****

= area of knowledge studied over time

****科目****

****lesson****

= one teaching period within that subject

****一堂課****

Compare:

> Physics is my favourite ****subject****.

> 物理是我最喜歡的科目。

> Today's physics ****lesson**** was about light.

> 今天的物理課是關於光。

28. lesson vs unit

****unit****

= organized section of a course or textbook, often containing several lessons

****單元****

****lesson****

= one teaching section or session

Depending on the textbook, a “lesson” itself can also function as a numbered unit.

29. lesson vs message

****message****

= idea communicated by a story, speech, event, etc.

****訊息；主旨****

****lesson****

= principle or warning that someone can learn from it

****啟示；教訓****

Compare:

> The film's **message** is about friendship.

> 電影的主旨是友情。

> The film teaches an important **lesson** about trust.

> 電影帶出一個關於信任的重要啟示。

30. lesson vs experience

experience

= event or situation someone goes through

經歷

lesson

= what that experience teaches you

教訓；啟示

Compare:

> Losing the competition was a difficult **experience**.

> 輸掉比賽是一段艱難的經歷。

> It taught me an important **lesson** about preparation.

> 它讓我學到關於準備的重要一課。

Meaning map

The central concept of **lesson** is:

something through which learning happens

From this develop:

Formal teaching

physics lesson

→ **物理課**

Private instruction

piano lesson

→ **鋼琴課**

Textbook material

Lesson 5

→ **第五課**

Experience

learn a lesson

→ **得到教訓**

Moral

lesson of the story

→ **寓意；啟示**

Warning

a lesson for others

→ **借鏡**

Professional reflection

lessons learned

→ **經驗教訓**

The passage uses the formal teaching-session sense:

a specific period of school instruction

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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lesson — teaching period	老師教授某科目或技能的一段時間；一堂課 / 課堂
lesson in + subject	關於某一科目或內容的一堂課
have a lesson	參加 / 上某一堂課
give/teach a lesson	為學生進行一堂教學
private lesson	個別或小班形式進行的私人教學
driving/music/swimming lesson	用來學習駕駛、音樂、游泳等技能的課
lesson — textbook unit	教材或課程中被劃分出來的一課 / 學習單元
Lesson 1/2/etc.	課本或課程中編號的一課
lesson — experience	從某段經歷中得到的教訓、經驗或理解
learn a lesson	因經驗而得到重要教訓或學到道理
learn your lesson	因犯錯或遇到不愉快後果而記取教訓

lesson — moral/message	從故事、事件或經驗中可學到的道理 / 啟示	
lesson for someone	可供某人警惕、借鏡或學習的教訓	
teach someone a lesson	透過懲罰或後果使某人記取教訓	
lesson from history	從歷史事件中得到的警告、啟示或經驗	
lessons learned	從專案、活動或經歷中總結出的經驗與教訓	
lesson plan	老師對一堂課內容、流程與目標所作的教學計畫	
lesson objective	一堂課預期學生達成的學習目標	
lesson — religious reading	宗教儀式中朗讀的一段經文	

Passage recap

> “...in my very first physics **lesson** in secondary school.”

Here:

lesson = “a period of teaching in which students are taught a particular subject”

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **一堂課**

* **課堂**

* **物理課**

Natural contextual translation:

我第一次認識她，是在中學的第一堂物理課上。

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

lesson

= “a period of time during which a subject or skill is taught”

一堂課；課堂；教學時段

It does not mean **教訓** here.

Compare:

> a physics **lesson**

> → **一堂物理課**

> learn a **lesson** from a mistake

> → **從錯誤中吸取教訓**

That classroom-versus-experience contrast is the main polysemy distinction to keep clear.